

Energy Fact

A toaster uses almost half as much energy as a full-sized oven

Crazy Cube

Rubik's Cube can be solved in 20 moves. Proving it required 35 years of computer time donated by Google to get it done

Q&A



Powering your device using USB is not advisable. A new adapter can be bought from the market for a really low price. Look for the power rating for the existing adapter and replace it. If the ADSL2 router is under warranty, then you can simply ask the manufacturer to replace the adapter for you.



Power adapters are inexpensive and easy to find in local electronics stores



Aero themes not working

I have installed Windows 7 yesterday on my PC. But I am not able to see any Aero themes on my desktop. It's somehow disabled. I tried to fix them from the Start menu. It says that my onboard solution does not support WDDM and that I have to upgrade my graphic card. Isn't there anything that I could do to force aero on my desktop?

My PC configuration is:

- Intel(R) 82915G/GV/910GL Express Chipset Family
- Intel Pentium 4 CPU 2.66 GHz
- 1 GB DDR 400 MHz RAM
- Windows 7 32-bit
- Onboard graphics solution max 222 MB.
- Would Vista be a better option?

Aakash Dhingra



Windows 7 requires a DirectX 9.0 Pixel Shader 2.0 compliant graphics card to run Aero themes. The 915GL graphics solution isn't able to use the Aero theme. You'll face similar problems with Vista.



No net access with new router

I recently bought a SMC Wireless broadband router (SMCWBR14S-N4) after reading the test results and reviews in the July 2010 issue. I have a wired BSNL ADSL modem (UT300R2U), which has been connected to a WAN port on the SMC router using an RJ45 cable. I have run the installation CD provided along with the router and configured all the required settings including PPPoE. I use a Lenovo Thinkpad R400 laptop which has an Intel Wi-Fi Link 5100 series WLAN card. I am able to find the wireless network

and connect to it from my laptop. However, I am unable to connect to the internet. I get a "Internet Explorer cannot display the page" error on IE. I've tried connecting using Mozilla Fire Fox browser as well, without any success. Internet works fine if I connect my laptop directly to the BSNL modem with an RJ45 cable. I've tried connecting an RJ45 cable to the wireless router (LAN port) and my laptop. But still cannot launch any site. I can ping the wireless router from my laptop. However, cannot ping any websites or the BSNL modem. DHCP is enabled on both the modem and router. The router has an IP of 192.168.2.1. The WLAN adapter on my laptop obtains the IP 192.168.2.100 and the regular adapter obtains 192.168.2.101.

The (DHCP) IP range set on the router is from 192.168.2.100 to 192.168.2.199. Security setting (on the router and laptop) is set to WPA-PSK with AES. The network diagnostic tool shows the error "CHAP authentication failed". Please advise!

Mahesh Lakshmanaswamy



Every ISP has a different way of authenticating with the server end. The ADSL modem should do that by itself, unless you've set it up to dial manually using the PC. If that's the case, you need to setup the authentication information in the SMC router. Some ISPs might even lock MAC addresses, so look for an option that lets you manually enter the MAC address for your PC on the router. You need to do this using the router firmware.



Do I permission to reinstall Windows?

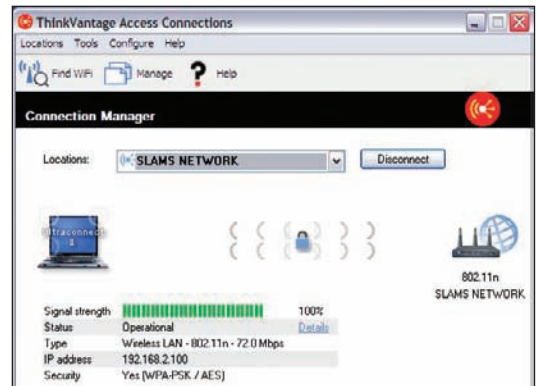
I am using Licensed version WinXP and have activated and upgraded from Microsoft. I am also using Microsoft Security essential to protect my PC. Now a days I am getting so many warning windows stating some DLL files are not found.

If I need to reformat my PC and reinstall WinXP, do I need to inform Microsoft or take their permission. Kindly help me with directions and addresses.

Ashok Chadha



You do not need to take any permis-



The router functioning, but without internet access

sion to reinstall Windows. Just make sure you have all the licensing information that is required when you reinstall it.

No DX10 and DX9 on Windows 7?

I have a HP Pavilion dv5 series laptop with the following configuration. Intel Core 2 Duo @ 2.0 GHz (T6400) 4.00 GB DDR3 RAM, 320 GB SATA hard disk, NVIDIA Geforce 9600 GT 512 MB (GDDR3) graphics card, Windows 7 Home Premium (32-bit) operating system.

Whenever I try to play FIFA 09 on my laptop, it says "graphics accelerator required". Earlier, I had Windows Vista (32-bit) installed, from which I upgraded to Windows 7 through HP's upgradation facility. At that time, while using Vista, the FIFA09 and other games would run smoothly; they don't anymore. Why is this happening?

Some people told me that NVIDIA GeForce 9600GT is a DirectX 10 card, and Windows 7 uses Directx 11, hence it is causing compatibility problems. Is it true? Does that mean that I will not be able to play any DirectX 10 (or DirectX 9) games? What should I do? Should I downgrade to Vista again? I intend to buy a few good DirectX 10 games this year.

Agniva Dey



Most likely, you haven't downloaded and reinstalled drivers for Windows 7. Download the necessary drivers for the graphics solution on your laptop from NVIDIA's site and give it a shot. Windows 7 can run DirectX 11, 10 and lower games as long as you have the necessary drivers installed. **d**